Test 18:

READING PASSAGE 1

Part 1

Read the text and answer questions 1–13.

A Brief History of Humans and Food

During the journey from our hunter-gatherer ancestors to the present day, there have been three seismic changes that have impacted the food we eat: the discovery of cooking, the emergence of agriculture, and the invention of methods of preserving food.

The 19th-century scientist Charles Darwin thought that cooking, after language, was the greatest discovery made by man. All of us eat some raw food, such as fruit and vegetables, but the great majority of food we consume is cooked. Cooking can turn plants that are inedible into edible food by destroying toxic chemicals that plants often manufacture to protect themselves against attack by insects or other herbivorous animals. These toxic chemicals are referred to as “plant secondary compounds” because they are not directly involved in the plant’s normal growth, development, and reproduction, and are produced purely as chemical defenses. They give many of the plants we consume, such as coffee or Brussels sprouts, their bitter taste.

Cooked food is often more digestible because heat breaks down tough cellulose cell walls in plants or tough connective tissue in animals. Chewing raw turnip, a plate of uncooked rice, or a raw leg of lamb is much harder work than eating the cooked equivalent. The energy expended in chewing to break down the tough material is replaced by energy from the fuel used in cooking the food, so the ratio of energy gained to energy expended by the body is greater when food is cooked.

Until the development of agriculture, hunter-gatherers spent up to seven hours a day gathering food. This all began to change around 10,500 years ago with the advent of farming, which led to dramatic changes in human societies. People began to create a variety of new tools to aid survival, and in turn, populations increased in size. These changes led to the possibility of specialization of different tasks within society. Around this time, writing became more sophisticated and allowed people to maintain records of the harvest and taxes. Eventually, formalized structures of government were established as people settled in one area.

The arrival of agriculture meant that, for the first time, our ancestors had more food than they could eat immediately. This, combined with the seasonality of production, led them to discover methods of preserving food: smoking, drying, adding acid by fermentation, or adding salt. These four methods all share one feature in common—they make the food a more hostile environment for bacteria that can cause it to spoil. They also tend to slow down natural chemical reactions in the food that would cause decay.

Although foods today are still preserved in these ancient ways, two more recent methods of preserving food have become more common: canning and freezing. Canning was invented by a Frenchman, Nicholas Appert, in the early 19th century. He sealed food in bottles fabricated from glass and then heated them in boiling water to cook the contents. Appert's method had great advantages over older methods of food preservation: it could be applied to a wide range of foods, and the flavor and texture were similar to freshly cooked products. His idea was soon copied by an Englishman, Peter Durand. Until this point, containers had been too heavy to be widely used, but Durand produced the first ones which were lightweight and resistant to damage. Two years later, in 1812, two Englishmen, Bryan Donkin and John Hall, started the commercial canning of food, although the real rise in popularity of canning had to wait until the invention of the can opener in 1855. Until then, cans were opened with a chisel and hammer. Canning is an extremely effective way of preserving food: one can containing meat, dating back to 1824, was opened in 1939, and the contents were still in good condition.

In the 21st century, the dominance of canning as a method of food preservation has been overtaken by freezing. Chilling food to keep it fresh is an old idea. The earliest mentions of icehouses, thick-walled buildings, half underground, date back to 1700 BC in northwest Iran. In early 16th-century Italy, water was mixed with chemicals to lower its freezing point to -18 degrees Celsius. Several centuries later, frozen fish and other goods were transported by ship from Australia to England. However, the modern frozen food industry was started in the 1920s by an American, Clarence Birdseye. While on a fishing trip with the Inuit in the Canadian Arctic, Birdseye observed that rapid freezing creates smaller ice crystals and therefore causes less damage to food—a discovery he had not expected. Nevertheless, the major growth in demand for frozen food came with the arrival of freezers in ordinary people's homes. The advantages of frozen over canned food include the fact that the flavor and consistency are often identical to the fresh product, and freezing can be used to preserve a wide variety of foods.

Questions 1-5

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?
In boxes 1-5 on your answer sheet, write:

TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

1. According to Darwin, cooking was the most significant development in human history.
2. The process of cooking gets rid of some plant poisons.
3. Eating cooked food is more energy efficient than eating raw food.
4. Clarence Birdseye had previously worked in the Australian food industry.
5. Birdseye's trip with the Inuit confirmed what he already believed about rapid freezing.

Questions 6-13

Complete the notes below.
Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.
Write your answers in boxes 6-13 on your answer sheet.

The development of agriculture and food preservation

- The changes agriculture brought about were:
    - The development of equipment and larger 6. _____
    - The ability to keep 7. _____ as writing developed
    - The setting up of organized government

Food Preservation

- Early methods of food preservation included:
    - Smoking

- Acid or 8. _____
- Adding salt

- **Canning**
  - Nicholas Appert put food into containers
  - Appert's method resulted in preserved food with the same taste and 9. _____ as fresh food
  - Peter Durand introduced cans that were lightweight and 10. _____
  - In 1855, the metal can opener replaced the 11. _____ and hammer used to open cans
  - Some food was still edible after more than 100 years, e.g., an old can of 12. _____

- **Freezing**
  - Rapid freezing prevents the formation of large ice crystals and causes less 13. _____

ĐÁP ÁN:

1. FALSE (Charles Darwin cho rằng nấu ăn là phát minh lớn thứ hai, sau ngôn ngữ, chứ không phải là phát minh quan trọng nhất).

o Location: Paragraph 2: "The 19th-century scientist Charles Darwin thought that cooking, after language, was the greatest discovery made by man."

2. TRUE (Nấu ăn giúp phá hủy các hóa chất độc hại mà thực vật tạo ra để tự bảo vệ).

o Location: Paragraph 2: "Cooking can turn plants that are inedible into edible food by destroying toxic chemicals that plants often manufacture to protect themselves..."

3. TRUE (Năng lượng tiêu tốn để nhai được thay thế bằng năng lượng từ nhiên liệu nấu nướng, giúp cơ thể nhận được nhiều năng lượng hơn).

o Location: Paragraph 3: "...the ratio of energy gained to energy expended by the body is greater when food is cooked."

4. NOT GIVEN (Bài đọc có nhắc đến tàu vận chuyển cá đông lạnh từ Úc đến Anh, nhưng không nói Clarence Birdseye từng làm việc trong ngành thực phẩm ở Úc).

o Location: Paragraph 6 mentions frozen fish being transported from Australia to England. Paragraph 7 mentions Clarence Birdseye.

5. FALSE (Việc đông lạnh nhanh tạo ra tinh thể băng nhỏ hơn và ít gây hại cho thực phẩm là một khám phá mà Birdseye không ngờ tới - "a discovery he had not expected").

o Location: Paragraph 7: "While Birdseye was on a fishing trip... he observed that very rapid freezing creates smaller ice crystals and therefore causes less damage to food. This was something he had not expected."

6. populations (Dẫn đến việc tạo ra công cụ mới và dân số tăng lên).

o Location: Paragraph 7: "While Birdseye was on a fishing trip... he observed that very rapid freezing creates smaller ice crystals and therefore causes less damage to food. This was something he had not expected."

7. records (Viết lách trở nên tinh vi hơn cho phép con người lưu giữ các ghi chép về thu hoạch và thuế).

o Location: Paragraph 4: "...writing became more sophisticated and allowed people to maintain records of the harvest and taxes."

8. salt (Bốn phương pháp bảo quản sớm bao gồm: xông khói, sấy khô, thêm axit hoặc thêm muối).

o Location: Paragraph 5: "...methods of preserving food: smoking, drying, adding acid by fermentation or adding salt."

9. glass (Nicolas Appert đóng kín thực phẩm trong các chai làm bằng thủy tinh).

o Location: Paragraph 6: "He sealed food in bottles fabricated from glass..."

10. texture (Phương pháp của Appert giữ được hương vị và cấu trúc tương tự như thực phẩm tươi).

o Location: Paragraph 6: "...the flavour of the food as well as the texture were similar to the freshly cooked product."

11. lightweight (Peter Durand đã sản xuất những chiếc hộp đầu tiên có trọng lượng nhẹ và khó bị hư hỏng).

o Location: Paragraph 6: "...the flavour of the food as well as the texture were similar to the freshly cooked product."

12. chisel (Trước khi có dụng cụ mở hộp, người ta phải dùng đục và búa để mở).

o Location: Paragraph 6: "Up to this time, cans were opened with a chisel which was used to break open the top when hit with a hammer."

13. meat (Một hộp chứa thịt từ năm 1824 vẫn ở tình trạng tốt khi được mở vào năm 1939).

o Location: Paragraph 6: "Up to this time, cans were opened with a chisel which was used to break open the top when hit with a hammer."

READING PASSAGE 2

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 14-26**, which are based on Reading Passage 2 below.*

Creative Problem-Solving

Puzzle-solving is an ancient, universal practice, scholars say, and it depends on creative insight

A In a recent study, researchers at Northwestern University in the United States found that people were more likely to solve word puzzles with sudden insight when they were amused, having just seen a short comedy routine. 'What we think is happening,' said Dr Mark Beeman, a neuroscientist who worked on the study, 'is that the humor, this positive mood, is lowering the brain's threshold for detecting weaker or more remote connections,' which enable people to solve puzzles.

B This suggests that the appeal of puzzles goes far deeper than the pleasant rush of finding a solution. The very act of doing a puzzle typically shifts the brain into an open, playful state that is itself a pleasing escape. Unlike the social and professional mysteries in the real world, puzzles are reassuringly solvable; but like any serious problem, they require more than mere intellect to crack. 'It's imagination, it's inference, it's guessing; and much of it is happening subconsciously,' said Dr Marcel Danesi, a professor of anthropology at the University of Toronto, Canada. 'It's all about you, using your own mind, without any method or schema, to restore order from chaos,' Danesi said. 'And once you have, you can sit back and say, "Hey, the rest of my life may be a disaster, but at least I have a solution."'

C For almost a century scientists have used puzzles to study what they call 'insight thinking', the leaps of understanding that seem to come out of the blue. In one experiment, the German psychologist Karl Duncker presented people with a candle, a box of pins, and the task of attaching the candle to a wall. About a quarter of the subjects thought to use the pins to tack the box to the wall as a support - some immediately, and others after failed efforts to tack wax to the wall. According to Duncker, the creative leap seems to have been informed by subconscious cues.

In another well-known experiment, psychologists H.G. Birch and H.s. Rabinowitz challenged people to tie together two cords; the cords were hanging from the ceiling of a large room, too far apart to be grabbed at the same time. A small percentage of people solved it without any help, by tying something else to one cord and swinging it like a pendulum so that it could be caught while they held the other cord. In some experiments researchers gave clues to those

who were stumped - for instance, by bumping into one of the strings so that it swung. Many of those who then solved the problem said they had no recollection of the clue, though it very likely registered subconsciously.

D All along, researchers have debated the definitions of insight and analysis, and some have concluded that the two are merely different sides of the same coin. Yet in an authoritative discussion of the research carried out so far, the psychologists Jonathan w. Schooler and Joseph Melcher concluded that the abilities most strongly correlated with insight problem-solving 'were not significantly correlated' with solving analytical problems. Either way, creative problem-solving usually requires both analysis and insight. Adam Anderson, a psychologist at the University of Toronto, Canada, argues that although when people are solving problems they may move back and forth between these abilities, they are truly different brain states.

E At first, studies did little more than confirm that brain areas that register reward spiked in activity when people came up with a solution, that is to say once they had completed a puzzle. However, in a series of recent studies, John Kounios, a psychologist at Drexel University in the United States, has imaged people's brains as they prepare to tackle a puzzle, but before they've seen it. Those whose brains show a particular signature of preparatory activity, one that is strongly correlated with positive moods, turn out to be more likely to solve the puzzles with sudden insight than with trial and error (the clues can be solved either way). Previous research has also found activation of cells in a certain area of the brain when people widen or narrow their attention - say, when they filter out distractions to focus on a difficult task, like concentrating on someone's voice in a noisy room. In the case of insight puzzle-solving, the brain seems to widen its attention, in effect making itself more susceptible to distraction.

F In the humor study, Beeman had college students solve word-association puzzles after watching a short video showing a stand-up comedian. Beeman found that these students solved more of the puzzles overall, and significantly more by sudden insight, compared with when they'd seen a scary or boring video beforehand. This 'open' state of mind does not only apply to intellectual puzzles. In a study published last year, researchers at the University of Toronto found that people in positive moods picked up more background detail, even when they were told to block out distracting information during a computer task. The findings fit with dozens of experiments linking positive moods to better creative problem solving. The implication is that positive mood engages this broad, ... attentional state that is both perceptual and visual,' said Anderson. He explains that not only are people in a positive mood able to think more broadly, they are able to notice more visually.

TRUE
IELTS

Questions 14 – 19

Reading Passage 2 has six paragraphs, **A-F**.

Which paragraph contains the following information?

*Write the correct letter, **A-F**, in boxes 14-19 on your answer sheet.*

NB You may use any letter more than one

14 a claim that people enjoy the process of doing puzzles as well as finding the answers

15 a review of studies that looked at the relationship between insight and analysis

16 the finding that people were less likely to solve puzzles after viewing uninteresting or disturbing material

17 a comparison between doing puzzles and dealing with life challenges

18 a description of a study where the subjects were given hints by those conducting the research

19 details of a study in which the focus shifted to mental activity before a puzzle is attempted

Questions 20 – 23

Look at the following statements (Questions 20-23) and the list of researchers below.

Match each statement with the correct researchers, ***A-E****.*

Write the correct letter, ***A-E****, in boxes 20-23 on your answer sheet.*

20 Solving a puzzle may help people facing difficulties feel better.

21 Two distinctly separate functions of the brain are used when solving puzzles.

22 Some subjects were able to find a solution to the puzzle they were given without knowing how they had done it.

23 Seeing something funny helps people make links that may not be obvious at first.

List of Researchers

A Mark Beeman
B Marcel Danesi
C Karl Duncker
D Adam Anderson
E John Kounios

Questions 24 – 26

Complete the summary below.

*Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.*

Write your answer in boxes 24-26 on your answer sheet.

Kounios builds on studies of puzzle-solvers' brain activity

Early studies showed that when people solved a puzzle, the parts of the brain linked to reward were more active. Studies by Kounios reveal that when people are feeling **24** ..... during the preparatory stage, it is more probable that they will use insight to solve puzzles. The part of the brain that is affected is connected with the adjustment of people's attention. When someone is trying to listen to a **25** ..... when the general sound level is high, the focus narrows. When people solve puzzles using insight, their focus becomes wider, and they are more open to **26** ..... .

IELTS

ĐÁP ÁN:

14. a claim that people enjoy the process of doing puzzles as well as finding the answers

Answer: B

Giải thích: Đoạn B nói rằng sức hấp dẫn của puzzle không chỉ nằm ở việc tìm ra đáp án mà còn ở chính quá trình giải.

“the appeal of puzzles goes far deeper than the pleasant rush of finding a solution. The very act of doing a puzzle…”

15. a review of studies that looked at the relationship between insight and analysis

Answer: D

Giải thích: Đoạn D bàn về tranh luận giữa “insight” và “analysis” và tổng kết nghiên cứu về mối liên hệ giữa chúng.

“researchers have debated the definitions of insight and analysis”
“Schooler and Melcher concluded that the abilities… were not significantly correlated”

16. the finding that people were less likely to solve puzzles after viewing uninteresting or disturbing material

Answer: F

Giải thích: Đoạn F mô tả thí nghiệm cho thấy sinh viên giải puzzle kém hơn sau khi xem video đáng sợ hoặc buồn chán.

“students solved more of the puzzles… after watching… a stand-up comedian”
“compared with when they’d seen a scary or boring video beforehand”

17. a comparison between doing puzzles and dealing with life challenges

Answer: B

Giải thích: Đoạn B so sánh puzzle với các vấn đề trong cuộc sống thực.

“Unlike the social and professional mysteries in the real world, puzzles are reassuringly solvable”
“the rest of my life may be a disaster, but at least I have a solution.”

18. a description of a study where the subjects were given hints by those conducting the research

Answer: C

Giải thích: Đoạn C nói về thí nghiệm dây thừng, trong đó nhà nghiên cứu đưa gợi ý bằng cách làm dây đung đưa.

“researchers gave clues to those who were stumped”
“by bumping into one of the strings so that it swung”

19. details of a study in which the focus shifted to mental activity before a puzzle is attempted

Answer: E

Giải thích: Đoạn E nói Kounios nghiên cứu hoạt động não bộ trước khi người tham gia nhìn thấy puzzle.

“has imaged people’s brains as they prepare to tackle a puzzle, but before they’ve seen it”

Questions 20–23

20. Solving a puzzle may help people facing difficulties feel better.

Answer: B (Marcel Danesi)

Giải thích: Danesi cho rằng giải được puzzle giúp con người cảm thấy ổn hơn dù cuộc sống hỗn loạn.

“restore order from chaos”
“the rest of my life may be a disaster, but at least I have a solution.”

21. Two distinctly separate functions of the brain are used when solving puzzles.

Answer: D (Adam Anderson)

Giải thích: Anderson nói insight và analysis là hai trạng thái não khác nhau.

“they are truly different brain states.”

22. Some subjects were able to find a solution to the puzzle they were given without knowing how they had done it.

Answer: C (Karl Duncker)

Giải thích: Trong các nghiên cứu ở đoạn C, nhiều người giải được puzzle nhưng không nhớ gợi ý đã giúp họ thế nào.

“Many of those who then solved the problem said they had no recollection of the clue”

23. Seeing something funny helps people make links that may not be obvious at first.

Answer: A (Mark Beeman)

Giải thích: Beeman cho rằng humour giúp não nhận ra các liên kết yếu hoặc xa.

“the humor… is lowering the brain’s threshold for detecting weaker or more remote connections”

Questions 24–26

24.

Answer: positive

Giải thích:

“strongly correlated with positive moods”

25.

Answer: voice

Giải thích:

“concentrating on someone’s voice in a noisy room”

26.

Answer: distraction

Giải thích:

“making itself more susceptible to distraction”

READING PASSAGE 3

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 27–40**, which are based on Reading Passage 3 below.*

200 Years of Australian Landscapes at the Royal Academy in London

This exhibition promises to chart the evolution of a nation through its art, but not everyone agrees with the reasons behind the choice of artwork.

For the casual viewer, the exhibition of landscapes, *Australia*, selected by the Royal Academy of Art, will be a spectacular guide through Australian art history. Included in the exhibition are a range of artists and styles, dating from the earliest days of colonial art and progressing through expressionism and modernism to the greats of the 20th century, culminating with the current generation of Australian artists. It is hardly surprising, then, that this results in a flexible, wide-ranging notion of landscape.

But this landmark exhibition gives rise to some questions, and perhaps problems, regarding Britain's relationship with its former colony. By choosing a style of painting at which British artists excel, the Academy could be seen as inviting criticism that hints at a telling attitude towards Australian art by comparison. But it is the very theme of landscape that provides the strongest connection to Australian art from Britain. To consider it condescending is perhaps too strong, but for Joanna Mendelssohn, an Australian critic and Associate Professor at the University of NSW's College of Fine Arts (COFA), there is a suggestion that British artistic values have directed this exhibition, rather than allowing Australia the freedom to demonstrate its maturity.

What Mendelssohn found surprising about this exhibition was that the underlying rules for the selection of works seemed to have been so conservative. Since the landscape is a very strong British artistic theme, it appeared to her that when the British looked to the art of a former colony, there was a tendency for them to think that those colonies would continue to be like the British themselves. In reviewing *Australia*, the British insisted on looking at the genre of landscape painting.

Because of colonial ties, it was inevitable during Australian art's formative years that it would reflect Britain's devotion to the beloved landscape before its own character and idiosyncrasies took shape. And while Mendelssohn's concern over the exhibition's conventional selection is valid, the Academy is nevertheless embracing the peculiarities of Australian art from the mid-19th century onward, albeit within the boundaries of landscape.

Australia is curated by Kathleen Soriano, director of exhibitions at the Royal Academy. "Certainly the influence of English, French, or German art is much more evident in the early periods, in the early 1800s to mid-1800s," she says. "What I wanted to show was how Australian art develops a real distinctiveness, associated with the landscape and the light."

The fusion of tradition of the European kind with something more specifically Australian, and often personal, is crucial to the exhibition, and extends particularly to some of the more

contemporary artists involved. Sydney-born video artist Shaun Gladwell is a good example of this. Gladwell's most famous piece, which is featured in the exhibition, is *Storm Sequence* (2000), a video of Gladwell skateboarding on the Bondi seafront as one of Sydney's signature brutal storms lingers offshore. It is his acknowledgment of landscape (or seascape) tradition, colored by Gladwell's own individualism. "To exhibit my work in this show might make some sense because I was interested in Turner and the idea of atmosphere affecting vision, something I was really interested in around the time of *Storm Sequence*. I was thinking about this tradition of Romantic landscape, but I wanted to make it personal," says Gladwell. But he didn't want to just embark on borrowing imagery from elsewhere. He wanted to bring it to his experience and his world through skateboarding and beach culture.

So while it may seem narrow for Britain to reduce Australian art to the genre of landscape, there can be little denying that British landscape painting is still relevant to a current generation of Australian practitioners, however indirectly.

Visitors to the exhibition encounter Australian Aboriginal art first, the idea being that these works warrant a prominent position because they were 'first'. Over the last couple of decades, London has hosted many successful exhibitions of Aboriginal art in smaller spaces, but for Soriano, *Australia* represents an opportunity to place such art in a broader context, with new relationships to the art of the settlers and white Australia. 'One of the reasons landscape makes sense as being the right theme was because Aboriginal art started in and on the landscape,' she says. '[The exhibition] is a beautiful meshing of the two different kinds of art, that allowed me to bring them together comfortably and honestly within this theme. It was important for me to present Indigenous art to audiences, and I felt it was most authentic that it was seen as part of Australian art history, rather than a separate area with a world of its own.'

Meanwhile, Australian critic Mendelssohn also points out that London is increasingly less important to today's generation of artists, and this somewhat weakens the ceremony surrounding the exhibition in London. 'China is the most important art market in the world,' she says. 'If you've made it in Shanghai, you've made it. The world has changed. My students in Australia, who come from all over the world, really want to see Venice Biennale and Art Basel, but they're less interested in going to London. When I was growing up, London was the destination, and then when I was at university all the smart young things wanted to go to New York,' she added. 'Now they want to go everywhere. There's no such thing as the centre and the periphery like there used to be. It's much more complicated.'

Questions 27–31

Do the following statements agree with the views of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

In boxes 27–31 on your answer sheet, write

YES — if the statement agrees with the views of the writer
NO — if the statement contradicts the views of the writer
NOT GIVEN — if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this

27 As expected, the artworks chosen for the exhibition reflect a narrow interpretation of landscape.

28 The Academy rejected Australian suggestions for the subject of the exhibition.

29 The colonial relationship meant that early Australian landscape painting followed the traditions of English landscape painting.

30 The exhibition reflects the fact that Australian art developed its own particular qualities.

31 Contemporary Australian artists have generally rejected British landscape traditions.

TRUE IELTS

Questions 32–36

Choose the correct letter, ***A, B, C,*** *or* ***D****.*

Write the correct letter in boxes 32–36 on your answer sheet.

32 What is the writer's main point in the second paragraph?

A Australian landscape painting derives from the British tradition.
B Australian landscape painting is more highly regarded than British.
C Britain is still imposing its principles on Australian art.
D British art cannot be compared to Australian art.

33 What does Joanna Mendelssohn find surprising?

A Modern Australian landscape painting has great variety.
B The guidelines for the choice of work were very traditional.
C Landscape painting remains a popular subject for British artists.
D The British find the Australian landscape unsuitable as a subject.

34 Shaun Gladwell's work is included in the exhibition because

A it adopts a subjective approach to depicting the landscape.
B skateboarding is an inspiration to many Australian artists.
C storms are a significant feature in the Australian landscape.
D Bondi is an iconic Australian location.

35 What was the reason for Soriano including Aboriginal art in the exhibition?

A It is not well known in London art circles.
B Aboriginal landscape painting influenced Australian settlers.
C It is part of the Australian art tradition and not independent of it.
D Modern Aboriginal painting deals with changes to the landscape.

36 By referring to China, Mendelssohn is making the point that

A having an exhibition in London is not as important as it used to be.
B young artists in Britain are not interested in Australian art.
C art from Shanghai is more important than Australian art.
D New York is still a preferred destination for young artists.

TRUE IELTS

Questions 37–40

*Complete each sentence with the correct ending, **A–F**, below.*

*Write the correct letter, **A–F**, in boxes 37–40 on your answer sheet.*

37 In spite of its conservatism, the Royal Academy exhibition

38 Australian art of the early to mid-1800s

39 The modern work by Gladwell chosen for the exhibition

40 Including Aboriginal art in the exhibition

A reflects the mood created by the natural environment.
B demonstrates that the dominant art form in Australia is landscape painting.
C demonstrates an understanding of the historical importance of the land.
D showcases a very small number of artists.
E demonstrates a strong European flavour.
F shows an acceptance of the unique qualities of Australian art.

TRUE IELTS

ĐÁP ÁN:

27. NO: Trái với mong đợi, các tác phẩm nghệ thuật được chọn cho triển lãm phản ánh một cách hiểu hẹp về phong cảnh (Đoạn 1: tác giả nói triển lãm mang lại một quan niệm "linh hoạt, phạm vi rộng" - *flexible, wide-ranging notion*).

28. NOT GIVEN: Học viện đã từ chối các đề xuất của Úc về chủ đề của triển lãm (Bài đọc nói về sự áp đặt giá trị nghệ thuật của Anh nhưng không đề cập cụ thể đến việc Úc đưa ra đề xuất và bị từ chối).

29. YES: Mối quan hệ thuộc địa đồng nghĩa với việc hội họa phong cảnh Úc thời kỳ đầu tuân theo các truyền thống của hội họa phong cảnh Anh (Đoạn 4: "...inevitable... it would reflect Britain’s devotion to the beloved landscape").

30. YES: Triển lãm phản ánh thực tế rằng nghệ thuật Úc đã phát triển những phẩm chất riêng biệt của nó (Đoạn 4 & 5: nhắc đến việc đón nhận những "đặc điểm riêng" - *peculiarities* và "sự khác biệt thực sự" - *real distinctiveness*).

31. NO: Các nghệ sĩ Úc đương đại nhìn chung đã từ bỏ các truyền thống phong cảnh của Anh (Đoạn 7: khẳng định hội họa phong cảnh Anh vẫn còn "liên quan" - *relevant* đối với thế hệ nghệ sĩ Úc hiện nay).

32. C: Điểm chính của tác giả ở đoạn 2 là Anh vẫn đang áp đặt các nguyên tắc của mình lên nghệ thuật Úc ("British artistic values have directed this exhibition").

33. B: Joanna Mendelssohn thấy ngạc nhiên khi các hướng dẫn cho việc lựa chọn tác phẩm rất truyền thống (*conservative*).

34. A: Tác phẩm của Shaun Gladwell được đưa vào triển lãm vì nó áp dụng cách tiếp cận chủ quan để mô tả phong cảnh (kết hợp truyền thống với trải nghiệm cá nhân về văn hóa lướt ván và bãi biển).

35. C: Lý do Soriano đưa nghệ thuật Thổ dân vào triển lãm là vì nó là một phần của truyền thống nghệ thuật Úc chứ không phải độc lập với nó.

36. A: Bằng cách nhắc đến Trung Quốc, Mendelssohn muốn nhấn mạnh rằng việc có một triển lãm ở London không còn quan trọng như trước đây.

37. F: Bất chấp sự bảo thủ của nó, triển lãm của Học viện Hoàng gia **cho thấy sự chấp nhận những phẩm chất độc đáo của nghệ thuật Úc**.

38. E: Nghệ thuật Úc từ đầu đến giữa những năm 1800 **thể hiện hương vị châu Âu mạnh mẽ**.

39. A: Tác phẩm hiện đại của Gladwell được chọn cho triển lãm **phản ánh tâm trạng được tạo ra bởi môi trường tự nhiên** (thông qua không khí của những cơn bão).

40. C: Việc đưa nghệ thuật Thổ dân vào triển lãm **cho thấy sự hiểu biết về tầm quan trọng lịch sử của vùng đất**.